

The Pythoneers · [Follow publication](#)

★ Member-only story

THINK YOU KNOW PYTHON? THINK AGAIN!

10 Surprising Python Facts You Probably Didn't Know! 🐍

Discover 10 surprising facts about Python that will change the way you see the language!



Aashish Kumar · [Follow](#)

Published in The Pythoneers

4 min read · Mar 11, 2025

▶ Listen

📄 Share

⋮ More



Photo by [Shutter Speed](#) on [Unsplash](#)

Python is one of the most loved programming languages, known for its simplicity, readability, and vast ecosystem.

But did you know Python has some hidden quirks and powerful features that many developers overlook?

Let's dive into 10 surprising Python facts that will blow your mind! 🤖

1. Python Wasn't Named After the Snake!

Most people assume Python is named after the snake, but it was actually named after the British comedy series “**Monty Python's Flying Circus**.”

Guido van Rossum, Python's creator, was a fan of the show and wanted a name that was short, unique, and slightly mysterious.

So, next time someone asks why it's called **Python**, tell them it's because of comedy, not reptiles!

2. Python Can Run Else After a Loop

Unlike most programming languages, Python allows you to use an **else statement with loops**!

```
for i in range(5):  
    print(i)  
else:  
    print("Loop completed!")
```

How does it work?

- The **else block runs only if the loop completes without a break statement.**
- If the loop is interrupted with **break**, the else part is skipped.

```
for i in range(5):  
    if i == 3:  
        break  
    print(i)  
else:  
    print("Loop completed!") # This won't print!
```

This feature is rarely used but can be **super handy** in certain cases!

3. Python Uses Indentation Instead of Braces

Most programming languages (like C, Java, JavaScript) use **curly braces** `{ }` to define blocks of code. Python, however, enforces **indentation**!

```
def greet():  
    print("Hello, world!") # Proper indentation
```

Why is this surprising?

- Python forces developers to **write clean and readable code** by design.
- No missing braces, no weird formatting – just **pure readability**!

4. Python Supports Negative Indexing

Did you know you can access list elements using **negative indices**?

```
numbers = [10, 20, 30, 40, 50]  
print(numbers[-1]) # 50 (last element)  
print(numbers[-2]) # 40 (second last element)
```

Why is this useful?

- No need to use `len()` to find the last element
- Makes working with lists and strings much easier.

5. Python Has a Zen Philosophy

Type the following in a Python shell:

```
import this
```

You'll see “**The Zen of Python**”, a set of guiding principles for writing Pythonic code.

Example principles:

“Beautiful is better than ugly.”

“Simple is better than complex.”

“Readability counts.”

Python is not just a language – it's a philosophy!

6. You Can Swap Two Variables Without a Temp Variable

Most languages require a temporary variable to swap values. But in Python, you can **swap variables in one line!**

```
a, b = 5, 10
a, b = b, a
print(a, b)  # 10, 5
```

Why is this cool?

- No need for an extra temp variable.
- Clean and readable syntax.

7. Python Has a Built-in HTTP Server

Did you know Python comes with a built-in **web server**? You can start one instantly using a single command!

```
python -m http.server 8000
```

Why is this useful?

- Quickly test web applications.
- Share files over a local network.
- No need for third-party tools!

Python lets you **multiply strings and lists** – something you can't do in most languages!

```
print("Hello " * 3)
# Output: Hello Hello Hello

print([1, 2, 3] * 2)
# Output: [1, 2, 3, 1, 2, 3]
```

- Makes repeating patterns **super easy!**
- No need for loops or manual concatenation.

In many languages, you need special data types to handle big numbers. But **Python automatically manages large integers!**

```
big_num = 10**100  
print(big_num)  
# Output: 1000000000000000000000000000000000000000... (100 digits)
```

- No int or long types – just use numbers normally!
- Python dynamically allocates memory.

<https://medium.com/pythoneers/10-surprising-python-facts-you-probably-didnt-know-efa5c7b62afa>

Python was created in **1989** by Guido van Rossum, while:

- JavaScript was created in **1995**
- Java was released in **1995**
- C# came in **2000**

Even though Python is **one of the most modern-looking languages**, it's older than most programming languages we use today!

Final Thoughts: Python is Full of Surprises!

Python is **simple, elegant, and powerful** – but also packed with **hidden gems** that make coding more fun and efficient!

Which Python fact surprised you the most? Let me know in the comments!

Open in app ↗

Medium



Search



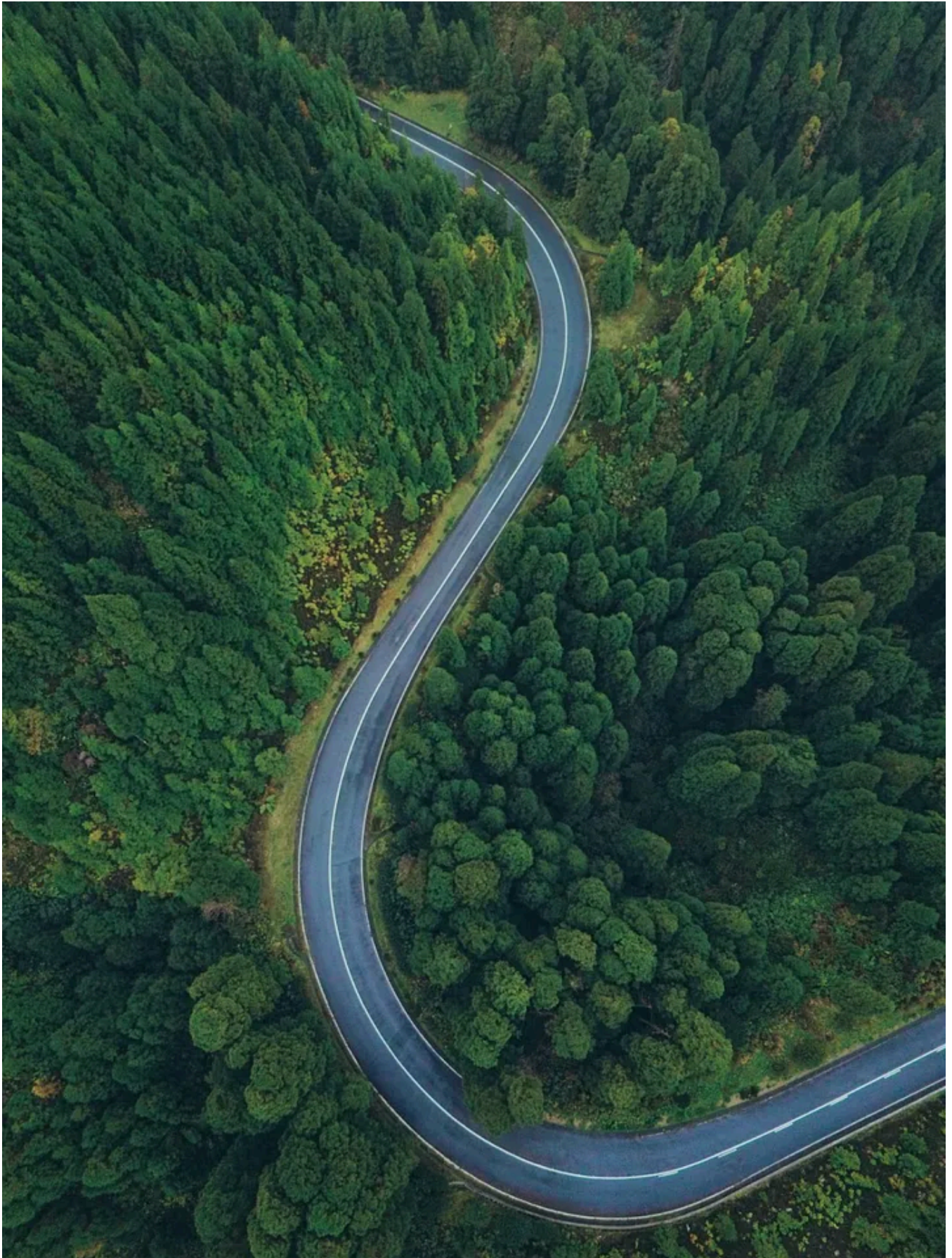


Photo by [Artem Stoliar](#) on [Unsplash](#)

Python

Python3

Python Programming

P y t h o n

Python Development

[Follow](#)

Published in The Pythoneers

13.1K Followers · Last published 6 days ago

Your home for innovative tech stories about Python and its limitless possibilities. Discover, learn, and get inspired.

[Follow](#)

Written by Aashish Kumar

837 Followers · 33 Following

Hi, I'm Aashish Kumar, a passionate software engineer from India IN, specialize in Python | Django | AI | LLM | Full Stack Development.

Responses (3)



Sandesh Chand

What are your thoughts?



Rishi Kulkarni
Mar 12



Felt so good reading this.



--



1 reply

[Reply](#)

Daimy

3 days ago



Most surprising facts : 2 & 10 😊



--



1 reply

[Reply](#)

Vignesh Rajamanickam

Mar 12 (edited)



good job...



--



1 reply

[Reply](#)

More from Aashish Kumar and The Pythoneers



In The Pythonworld by Aashish Kumar

Best Practices for Structuring a Python Project Like a Pro! 🚀

Follow these best practices to structure your Python projects like a pro – clean, scalable, and maintainable!

★ Mar 14



☐ In The Pythoneers by Abhay Parashar

18 Insanely Useful Python Automation Scripts I Use Everyday

Scripts That Increased My Productivity and Performance Even More

★ Dec 18, 2024



☐ In The Pythoneers by Abhay Parashar

17 Mindblowing GitHub Repositories You Never Knew Existed

Repositories To Bookmark Right Away

★ Dec 16, 2024



☐ In The Pythonworld by Aashish Kumar

10 Modern Python Tools Every Developer Should Master in 2025

Master 10 modern Python tools that will boost your productivity and efficiency in 2025.

★ Mar 8



See all from Aashish Kumar

See all from The Pythoneers

Recommended from Medium



In Python in Plain English by Coders Stop

7 Python Libraries That Will Make Your Code Worse—But Your Life Better

Ever found yourself staring at elegant, production-ready code and thinking, “This is beautiful... but it took me three days to write”? You’re...



Mar 26



Sebastian Carlos

Fired From Meta After 1 Week: Here's All The Dirt I Got

This is not just another story of a disgruntled ex-employee. I'm not shying away from the serious corporate espionage or the ethical...

★ Jan 8



☐ In Science Spectrum by Laurel W

Simple Ways to Tell if Python Code Was Written by an LLM

Yes, We Can Tell

★ Mar 22



☐ In Effective Programmer by Naveed Khan

High Performance Python

Simple and Effective Optimization Techniques for Python

★ Mar 9



☐ In Let's Code Future by Let's Code Future

11 Open-Source Projects That are Legit Game-Changers

Really unique and valuable

★ Mar 24



☐ In Level Up Coding by Liu Zuo Lin

5 Things I Learnt About Production-Grade Error Handling In Python

When you work with software, you need to deal with errors and exceptions—there's no way around this.

★ 6d ago



See more recommendations